



# Terra Vista Sprinkler Winterization

User manual for the sign-up and scheduling website

Neighbors

Administrator

Technician

2026 season · Plymouth, MN

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**About the screenshots.** They were taken with made-up sample neighbors and phone numbers. In these pictures the maps are shown as a plain grid with the same pins and route line. On the live site you'll see real Google Maps streets underneath.

## CHAPTER 1

# Overview

The website lets Terra Vista neighbors sign up to have their irrigation system winterized. It schedules everyone onto service days, plans the technician's route, and texts neighbors as the technician gets close.

## The four pages

| PAGE                      | WHO USES IT   | WHAT IT'S FOR                                                                             |
|---------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Main page /               | Neighbors     | The sign-up form. This is the address to share with the neighborhood.                     |
| Private registration link | Each neighbor | Sent to them by text. Shows their date and place in line, and lets them change or cancel. |
| /admin.html               | Administrator | Open dates, manage every sign-up, see the map, export a spreadsheet, check texts.         |
| /tech.html                | Technician    | The day's route, "up next", mark houses complete, share location.                         |

The staff pages are password protected. The administrator password also opens the technician page.

## How a season works

|                                                               |                                                                                            |                                                                                              |                                                                                              |                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Open dates</b><br>The administrator adds service dates. | <b>2. Neighbors sign up</b><br>They pick every day that works, and a time of day for each. | <b>3. Route is planned</b><br>The site orders each day's houses by location and time of day. | <b>4. Service day</b><br>The technician starts the day. Texts go out as each house comes up. | <b>5. Wrap up</b><br>Unfinished houses move to the next open day. |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Morning, afternoon, or any time

For each day that works, a neighbor picks one of:

- **Morning** They want the morning of that day.
- **Afternoon** They want the afternoon.
- **Any time** Either is fine. The site places them in whichever half fits the route best.

Each date has a **morning limit (10)** and an **afternoon limit (15)**, 25 houses in total. The administrator can change these for any date. When one half fills up, neighbors can still choose the other half or "any time" for that date. When both halves are full, the date shows **Full**.

A neighbor is scheduled on the **earliest** date they picked that has room for the time they chose. Their other dates are kept as backups in case the visit has to move.

# For neighbors

## Signing up


**Terra Vista Sprinkler Winterization**  
 (Site by Andy Witzke)

**Sign up for winterization**  
 Sign up for irrigation system winterization by Randy Kutter. Cost for 2026 is \$65, paid at time of service. Tell us where you live and which days work for you, and we'll text you a confirmation. On service day you'll get a text when you're 2nd in line, when you're next, and when your system is done.

**Name**

**Mobile phone**

**Street address (house number and street)**

**Notes** (special requests, access, where the valve or controller is, etc.)

The sign-up page on a phone

Open the website on a phone or computer. The top of the page explains the service and the price for the season.

- 1 Enter your **name**, **mobile phone number** and **street address** (house number and street is enough).
- 2 Add any **notes** for the technician, for example gate codes, pets, or where the valve or controller is.
- 3 Under **Which days work for you?**, tick every date you could make work.
- 4 For each ticked date, choose **Morning**, **Afternoon** or **Any time**.
- 5 Leave **Text me about my appointment** ticked to get text updates.
- 6 Tap **Sign me up**.

**Name**

Alex Rivera

**Mobile phone**

(763) 555-0199

**Street address (house number and street)**

16455 58th Ave N

**Notes** (special requests, access, where the valve or controller is, etc.)

Side gate is unlocked. Controller is in the garage.

**Which days work for you?**

Pick every day you could make work, and whether mornings, afternoons, or any time is best. We'll schedule you on the earliest one with room.

☐ **Monday, October 5** Morning 6 left · Afternoon 11 left

☒ **Tuesday, October 6** Morning 9 left · Afternoon 14 left

Morning Afternoon Any time

☒ **Wednesday, October 7** Morning full · Afternoon 15 left

Morning (full) Afternoon Any time

☒ Text me about my appointment (confirmation, "you're next" alerts, and completion). Msg & data rates may apply. Reply STOP to opt out.

**Sign me up**

Choosing dates. The morning of Oct 7 is full, so it's crossed out.

## Reading the date list

Each date shows how many spots are left, for example *Morning 9 left · Afternoon 14 left*.

- If the morning or afternoon of a date is full, that choice is **crossed out**. You can still pick the other half or **Any time**.
- If a date is completely full it shows **Full** and can't be ticked.

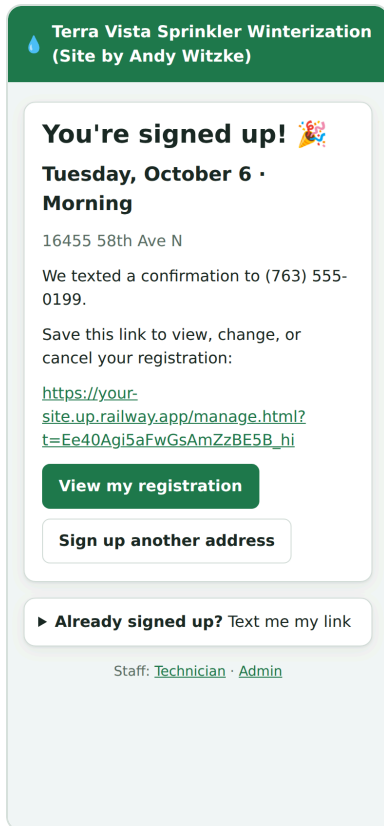
**Tip:** Ticking more than one date makes it more likely you'll get an early slot. You're booked on the earliest one with room. The others are only used if your visit has to be moved.

## If something goes wrong

A red message explains what to fix, such as a missing name or a phone number that isn't 10 digits. If the dates you picked fill up while you're signing up, the list refreshes. Pick another date and try again.

If you're already signed up for that address, the site texts you your private link again instead of creating a second booking.

## Your confirmation



After signing up

The page shows the date and time of day you're booked for. If you asked for texts, you'll also get a confirmation text.

Both include your **private link**. Keep it: it's how you check your booking and make changes. Anyone with the link can see and change your registration, so don't post it publicly.

**Lost your link?** At the bottom of the main page, open **Already signed up? Text me my link**, enter your mobile number and tap **Send link**.

## Changing or cancelling

**Terra Vista Sprinkler Winterization**

Your registration

**Tuesday, October 6 - Morning**

We'll text you when you're 2nd in line, when you're next, and when it's done.

16455 58th Ave N

**Update your details**

**Name**

Alex Rivera

**Mobile phone**

(763) 555-0199

**Street address**

16455 58th Ave N

**Notes** (gate code, dogs, valve location, etc.)

Side gate is unlocked. Controller is in the garage.

**Days that work for you**

☐ **Monday, October 5** Morning 6 left - Afternoon 11 left

☒ **Tuesday, October 6** Morning 8 left - Afternoon 14 left

Your private registration page (top part)

Open your private link. The top card shows your current booking. Below it you can:

- Change your name, phone, address or notes.
- Change which days work for you and the time of day for each.
- Turn text updates on or off.

Tap **Save changes**. If you choose different dates, you're rebooked on the earliest one with room, and you get a new confirmation text.

To cancel, tap **Cancel my sign-up** and confirm. You can sign up again later from the main page.

**On your service day**, once the technician has started, you can no longer change the date or address here. Call or text the organizer instead. You can still update your notes.

## On your service day

**Terra Vista Sprinkler Winterization**

Your registration

**You're 2nd in line**

Work is underway today (any time preference).

5810 Ranchview Ln, Plymouth, MN 55446, USA

Your place in line updates automatically

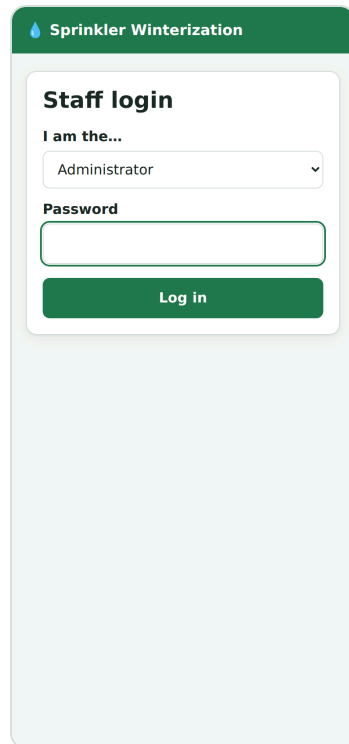
Once the technician starts the day, you'll get texts:

1. **You're 2nd in line:** the technician has one more stop before yours.
2. **You're next:** the technician is on the way. Please unlock gates and make sure the valve is reachable.
3. **Done:** your system has been winterized, with any notes from the technician.

Your private link also shows your place in line and refreshes every 30 seconds.

If the technician can't get to you that day, you'll get a text with your new date.

# Staff login



The staff login page

Go to `/admin.html` or `/tech.html`. If you aren't logged in, the login page opens.

- 1 Choose **Technician** or **Administrator**.
- 2 Enter the password.
- 3 Tap **Log in**.

You stay logged in on that device for two weeks, or until you tap **Log out** at the top of the page.

**Passwords** are set by whoever manages the hosting (see the Appendix). The administrator password works on both logins. If you change a password, everyone has to log in again.

## CHAPTER 4

# For the administrator

The admin page has five tabs: **Sign-ups**, **Dates**, **Map**, **Text log** and **Settings**. Links at the top open the public sign-up page and the technician view.

## Dates: opening days for sign-up

Winterization Admin

[Sign-up page](#) [Technician view](#) [Log out](#)

Sign-ups

Dates

Map

Text log

Settings

Open dates for sign-up

Date

Through (optional range)

Morning limit

Afternoon limit

☐ Include weekends

Add date(s)

mm/dd/yyyy

mm/dd/yyyy

10

15

| DATE                 | BOOKED                                              | MORNING LIMIT | AFTERNOON LIMIT | OPEN TO PUBLIC                      | STATUS      |           |     |                      |        |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------|-------------|-----------|-----|----------------------|--------|
| Monday, October 5    | 12/25<br>Morning 4<br>· Afternoon 4<br>· Any time 4 | 10            | 15              | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Not started | Tech view | Map | Roll over unfinished | Delete |
| Tuesday, October 6   | 4/25<br>Morning 2<br>· Afternoon 1<br>· Any time 1  | 10            | 15              | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Not started | Tech view | Map | Roll over unfinished | Delete |
| Wednesday, October 7 | 2/17<br>Morning 2<br>· Afternoon 0<br>· Any time 0  | 2             | 15              | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Not started | Tech view | Map | Roll over unfinished | Delete |

The Dates tab. Oct 7 has its morning limit lowered to 2.

## Adding dates

- 1 Pick a **Date**. To add several days at once, also pick a **Through** date.
- 2 Tick **Include weekends** if the range should include Saturdays and Sundays (they're skipped otherwise).
- 3 Set the **Morning limit** and **Afternoon limit** (10 and 15 unless you change them).
- 4 Click **Add date(s)**.

## The dates list

| COLUMN / BUTTON | WHAT IT DOES |
|-----------------|--------------|
|-----------------|--------------|

|                           |                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Booked                    | Total booked out of the day's limit, then how many chose morning, afternoon, and any time. <b>Full</b> means no spots are left. |
| Morning / Afternoon limit | Type a new number to change it. It saves as soon as you click away.                                                             |
| Open to public            | Untick to stop new sign-ups for that date. People already booked stay booked.                                                   |
| Status                    | <b>Not started, In progress</b> (the technician started it) or <b>Done</b> .                                                    |
| Tech view / Map           | Open that date in the technician view, or on the Map tab.                                                                       |
| Roll over unfinished      | Moves every house on that date that isn't complete to its next available day, and texts them.                                   |
| Reset status              | Shown for started or finished days. Sets the day back to Not started, for example after a test run.                             |
| Delete                    | Removes the date. If people are booked on it, you're warned first. If you go ahead, they're marked <b>Needs a date</b> .        |

## Sign-ups: everyone who registered

**Winterization Admin**

[Sign-up page](#)
[Technician view](#)
[Log out](#)

**Sign-ups**
Dates
Map
Text log
Settings

All dates
All active
Search name, address, phone
+ Add sign-up
↓ Export CSV

Total18

Scheduled18

Completed0

Needs a date0

Not on map1

| DATE       | # | TIME                  | NAME / ADDRESS                      | PHONE          | NOTES                          | OK DAYS                          | STATUS                                                                  |
|------------|---|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon, Oct 5 | 1 | Morning               | Sam Nguyen<br>5745 Terra Vista Ln   | (763) 555-0103 |                                | Mon, Oct 5 AM<br>Tue, Oct 6 ANY  | <div>Scheduled</div> <div>Edit</div> <div>Next day →</div> <div>✕</div> |
| Mon, Oct 5 | 2 | Morning               | Jordan Berg<br>5720 Terra Vista Ln  | (763) 555-0102 | Dog in the backyard, friendly. | Mon, Oct 5 AM<br>Tue, Oct 6 ANY  | <div>Scheduled</div> <div>Edit</div> <div>Next day →</div> <div>✕</div> |
| Mon, Oct 5 | 3 | Morning               | Pat Olson<br>16410 58th Ave N       | (763) 555-0100 | Valve box is by the side gate. | Mon, Oct 5 AM<br>Tue, Oct 6 ANY  | <div>Scheduled</div> <div>Edit</div> <div>Next day →</div> <div>✕</div> |
| Mon, Oct 5 | 4 | Morning               | Chris Lindqvist<br>16435 58th Ave N | (763) 555-0101 |                                | Mon, Oct 5 AM<br>Tue, Oct 6 ANY  | <div>Scheduled</div> <div>Edit</div> <div>Next day →</div> <div>✕</div> |
| Mon, Oct 5 | 5 | Any time<br>→ morning | Casey Johnson<br>5810 Ranchview Ln  | (763) 555-0106 | Controller is in the garage.   | Mon, Oct 5 ANY<br>Tue, Oct 6 ANY | <div>Scheduled</div> <div>Edit</div> <div>Next day →</div> <div>✕</div> |

## The Sign-ups tab

- **Filters:** show one date (or **Needs a date**), and one status. The search box matches name, address, phone and notes.
- **Counts** across the top: total, scheduled, completed, needing a date, and **Not on map** (addresses Google couldn't find).
- **#** is the house's position in that day's route. **Time** shows what they chose. For "any time" neighbors it also shows which half of the day they were placed in.
- **OK days** lists every date the neighbor said works, with their time of day for each.

| BUTTON     | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edit       | Change anything about the sign-up (see below).                                                                                                                                       |
| Next day → | Moves the house to the next open date with room for their time of day, preferring dates they picked. They get a text. If no date has room, they're marked <b>Needs a date</b> .      |
| ×          | Deletes the sign-up permanently. No text is sent. To keep a record instead, use Edit and set Status to Cancelled (that doesn't text them either, so let the neighbor know yourself). |

retry (under "Not located")

Asks Google to find the address again, for example after you fix a typo.

## Adding or editing a sign-up

**Edit sign-up**

**Name** **Phone**

Taylor Swanson (763) 555-0104

**Address**

16520 57th Ave N

16520 57th Ave N, Plymouth, MN 55446, USA

**Neighbor notes**

Gate code 4417

**Scheduled day** **Time of day**

Mon, Oct 5 (12/25) Any time

**Status** **Technician notes**

Scheduled

**Other days that work**

☒ **Monday, October 5** Morning 6 left · Afternoon 11 left

Morning Afternoon Any time

The edit window

Click **+ Add sign-up** (for someone who called or emailed), or **Edit** on a row.

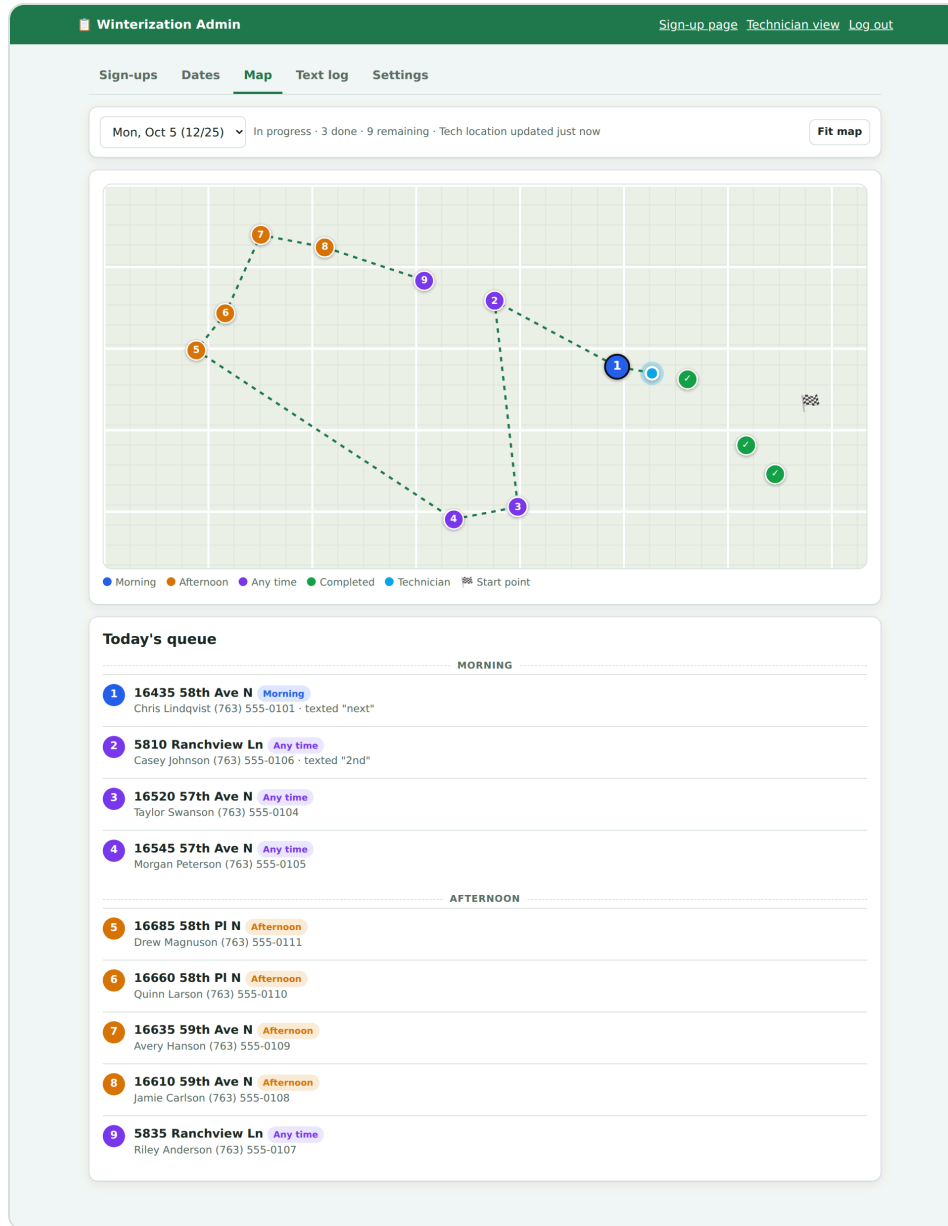
- **Scheduled day** and **Time of day** place them directly on a date.
- **Status**: Scheduled, Completed, Needs a date, or Cancelled.
- **Technician notes** appear in their "done" text.
- **Other days that work** are the backup dates used for moves.
- **Allow over capacity** lets you book someone even when that half of the day is full.
- **Send confirmation text** (new sign-ups) or **Text them if their date changes** (edits).

A name, a 10-digit phone number and an address are required.

## Exporting a spreadsheet

Click **↓ Export CSV**. The file opens in Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets. It uses the same date and status filters as the list, so set those first to export one day. The columns are: service date, time preference, planned half of the day, route number, status, name, address, the address as Google found it, phone, neighbor notes, technician notes, acceptable dates, whether texts are allowed, completion time and sign-up time.

# Map: where everyone is



The Map tab during a service day

Choose a date to see its houses numbered in route order. Colors show morning (blue), afternoon (orange) and any time (purple). Completed houses have a green check. The technician is the light-blue dot, and  is the start point. The dashed line is the rest of the route. Below the map, **Today's queue** lists the remaining stops under Morning and Afternoon headings, and notes who has already been texted. Choose **All sign-ups** to see every registration at once.

The map refreshes every 20 seconds. Click a pin to see the neighbor's details, or use **Fit map** to zoom to all pins.

## Text log: every message sent

Winterization Admin

[Sign-up page](#)
[Technician view](#)
[Log out](#)

Sign-ups

Dates

Map

Text log

Settings

| WHEN                  | TO                                    | TYPE     | MESSAGE                                                                                                                                                                         | STATUS    |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0106<br>5810 Ranchview Ln   | second   | Terra Vista Winterization: You're 2nd in line! Our technician will be at 5810 Ranchview Ln after one more stop.                                                                 | simulated |
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0101<br>16435 58th Ave N    | next     | Terra Vista Winterization: You're next! Our technician is heading to 16435 58th Ave N now. Please make sure gates are unlocked and the backflow/shutoff valve is accessible.    | simulated |
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0100<br>16410 58th Ave N    | complete | Terra Vista Winterization: Your irrigation system at 16410 58th Ave N has been winterized. Technician notes: Blew out 7 zones. Thank you!                                       | simulated |
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0101<br>16435 58th Ave N    | second   | Terra Vista Winterization: You're 2nd in line! Our technician will be at 16435 58th Ave N after one more stop.                                                                  | simulated |
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0100<br>16410 58th Ave N    | next     | Terra Vista Winterization: You're next! Our technician is heading to 16410 58th Ave N now. Please make sure gates are unlocked and the backflow/shutoff valve is accessible.    | simulated |
| 9/26/2026, 4:08:23 AM | (763) 555-0102<br>5720 Terra Vista Ln | complete | Terra Vista Winterization: Your irrigation system at 5720 Terra Vista Ln has been winterized. Technician notes: Blew out 5 zones. Replaced a cracked backflow cover. Thank you! | simulated |
| 9/26/2026,            | (763) 555-                            | second   | Terra Vista Winterization: You're 2nd in line! Our technician will be at 16410 58th Ave                                                                                         | simulated |

The Text log tab

Shows the latest 500 texts, newest first, with the full message. The **Status** column shows:

- **sent:** accepted by Twilio for delivery.
- **failed:** Twilio refused it. The reason appears underneath (for example an invalid number).
- **simulated:** Twilio isn't set up yet, so the text was only recorded here, not sent. This is what the screenshot shows.

# Settings

**Winterization Admin** [Sign-up page](#) [Technician view](#) [Log out](#)

[Sign-ups](#) [Dates](#) [Map](#) [Text log](#) **[Settings](#)**

**Route start point**  
Where the technician begins each day (e.g. the neighborhood entrance). Used to plan the route until the technician shares their live location.

**Start address**

16400 58th Ave N

16400 58th Ave N, Plymouth, MN 55446, USA

**Save**

**Integrations**

- ⚠️ Twilio text messages — not configured; texts are logged but not sent
- ✅ Google Maps (browser)
- ✅ Google Geocoding (server)
- Links in texts point to `https://your-site.up.railway.app`

These are configured with environment variables on the server. See the README.

The Settings tab

**Route start point** is where the technician begins each day, such as the neighborhood entrance. It's used to plan routes until the technician shares their live location. Enter an address and click **Save**. The line below shows the address Google found. Leave it blank to let the route start at whichever end of the neighborhood works best.

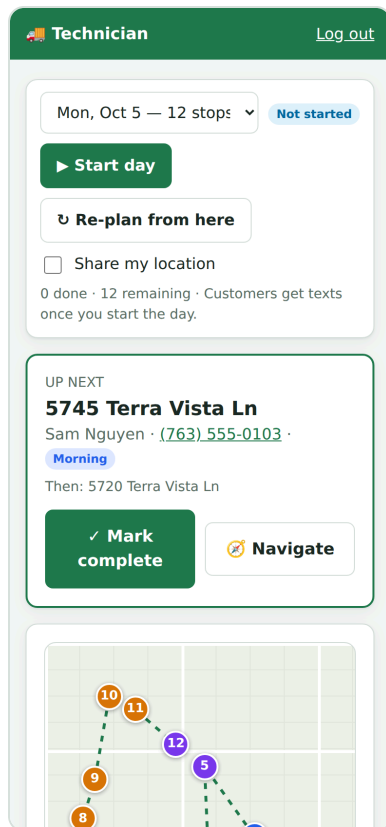
**Integrations** shows whether texting and Google Maps are set up, and the web address used in text links. These are changed in the hosting settings (see the Appendix).

## CHAPTER 5

# For the technician

The technician page is designed for a phone. Log in at `/tech.html`. It opens the day in progress, or else today or the next upcoming date. Use the date menu at the top to switch days.

## Before you start



A day that hasn't started yet

The page shows the planned route: a map and a numbered list under **Morning** and **Afternoon** headings.

- Morning houses come first, in driving order from the start point. Afternoon houses continue from where the morning ends.
- "Any time" houses are placed in whichever half is closest, without going over that half's limit.
- Until you start, the route updates by itself whenever someone signs up or changes their booking.

Tick **Share my location** and allow location when your phone asks. Your position then shows on the map for you and the administrator. If you said no by mistake, turn location back on for this site in your browser settings.

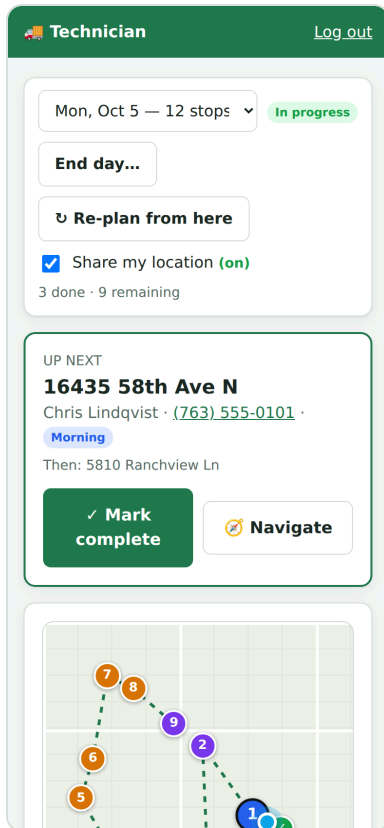
**No texts go out yet.** Neighbors aren't texted about their place in line until you tap **Start day**.

## Starting the day

Tap ► **Start day**. This:

- locks in the current route order, so it no longer rearranges itself,
- texts the first house **"you're next"** and the second house **"you're 2nd in line"**,
- turns on location sharing if it isn't already on.

## Working through the queue



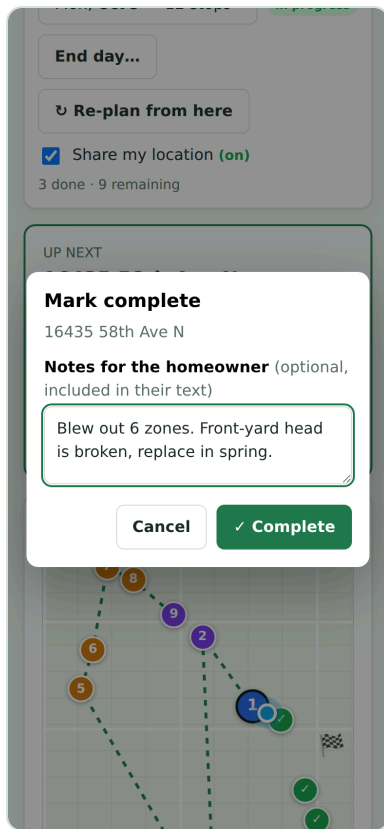
The "Up next" card and map during the day

The **Up next** card shows the next house: address, name, phone number, time of day, and the neighbor's notes (highlighted in yellow). It also shows the house after it.

-  **Navigate** opens Google Maps with driving directions to the house.
- Tap the **phone number** to call the neighbor.
- ✓ **Mark complete** when you're done (see below).

On the map, the dark-outlined pin is the next stop. The blue dot is you, and the dashed line is the rest of the route.

The summary under the buttons shows how many houses are done and how many remain. The page refreshes every 30 seconds.



Marking a house complete

## Marking a house complete

- 1 Tap ✓ **Mark complete** (or ✓ **Complete** on any house in the list).
- 2 Optionally type notes for the homeowner, such as how many zones you blew out or anything that needs repair. These notes are included in their text.
- 3 Tap ✓ **Complete**.

The homeowner gets a "done" text. The next house gets "you're next", and the one after gets "you're 2nd in line".

## Changing the order

- ▲ / ▼ move a house up or down the list. Moving a house to the top texts them that they're next.
- ⌵ **Re-plan from here** re-orders all remaining houses starting from where you are now. It still keeps morning houses before afternoon ones.

## Can't do a house today?

Tap **Move to next day** on it. The house moves to the next open date with room for their time of day, and the neighbor gets a text with the new date.

MORNING

1

16435 58th Ave N Morning

Chris Lindqvist · (763) 555-0101

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

2

5810 Ranchview Ln Any time

Casey Johnson · (763) 555-0106

Controller is in the garage.

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

3

16520 57th Ave N Any time

Taylor Swanson · (763) 555-0104

Gate code 4417

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

4

16545 57th Ave N Any time

Morgan Peterson · (763) 555-0105

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

AFTERNOON

5

16685 58th PI N Afternoon

Drew Magnuson · (763) 555-0111

Backflow on north side of house.

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

6

16660 58th PI N Afternoon

Quinn Larson · (763) 555-0110

✓ Complete

Navigate

▲

▼ Move to next day

The queue list, split into Morning and Afternoon

## The queue list

Below the map, every remaining house is listed in route order under **Morning** and **Afternoon** headings. The circle color matches the neighbor's choice: blue morning, orange afternoon, purple any time. Each house has ✓ **Complete**, **Navigate**, ▲▼ and **Move to next day** buttons. If Google couldn't find an address, the house says *not on map*.

## Completed houses

▼ Completed (3)

✓

5745 Terra Vista Ln Morning

Sam Nguyen · (763) 555-0103

Completed 4:08 AM · Blew out 6 zones.

Undo

✓

5720 Terra Vista Ln Morning

Jordan Berg · (763) 555-0102

Dog in the backyard, friendly.

Completed 4:08 AM · Blew out 5 zones.  
Replaced a cracked backflow cover.

Undo

✓

16410 58th Ave N Morning

Pat Olson · (763) 555-0100

Valve box is by the side gate.

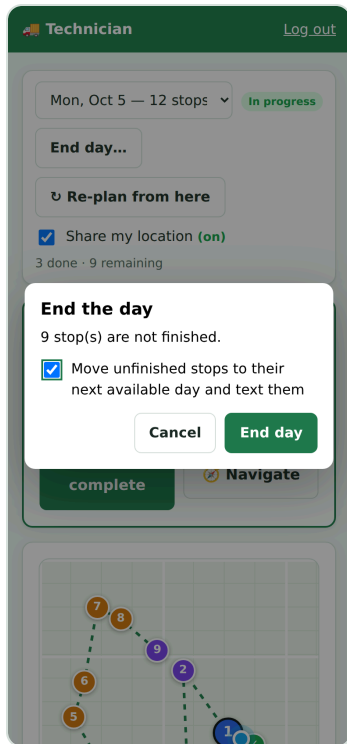
Completed 4:08 AM · Blew out 7 zones.

Undo

Completed houses, with Undo

Tap **Completed** at the bottom of the page to see finished houses, the time each was done, and your notes. Marked one by mistake? Tap **Undo**. The house goes back to the top of the queue, and the homeowner isn't sent another "done" text.

## Ending the day



Ending the day with houses left

Tap **End day...** If houses are left, leave **Move unfinished stops to their next available day and text them** ticked, then tap **End day**.

- Each unfinished house moves to the next open date with room for its time of day. Dates the neighbor picked are tried first.
- Each neighbor gets a text with their new date.
- A house with nowhere to go is marked **Needs a date** for the administrator. That neighbor is texted that they'll be rescheduled.

Ended a day too early? Choose that date again and tap ► **Reopen day**.

## Location tips

- Location only updates while the technician page is **open on screen**. Phones pause it when the screen locks or the browser is in the background, so reopen the page between houses.
- Your position is sent about every 15 seconds. The administrator's map hides it if it's more than 30 minutes old.
- Untick **Share my location** to stop sharing.

## CHAPTER 6

# Text messages

Texts go only to neighbors who ticked **Text me about my appointment**. Every text is listed on the admin **Text log** tab. Each one starts with "*Terra Vista Winterization:*". Cancelling or deleting a sign-up from the admin page doesn't send a text.

| WHEN                                       | WHAT IT SAYS (EXAMPLE)                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Right after signing up                     | You're signed up for Mon, Oct 5 (morning) at 16410 58th Ave N. We'll text you when you're 2nd in line, next, and when it's done. Edit or cancel: <i>[private link]</i><br>Reply STOP to opt out. |
| Their booking moves to a new date          | Your winterization at 16410 58th Ave N has been moved to Tue, Oct 6 (any time). Details or changes: <i>[private link]</i>                                                                        |
| Moved, but no date has room                | We weren't able to get to 16410 58th Ave N on Mon, Oct 5. We'll text you as soon as it's rescheduled. Sorry for the delay!                                                                       |
| 2nd in line (service day)                  | You're 2nd in line! Our technician will be at 16410 58th Ave N after one more stop.                                                                                                              |
| Next (service day)                         | You're next! Our technician is heading to 16410 58th Ave N now. Please make sure gates are unlocked and the backflow/shutoff valve is accessible.                                                |
| Done                                       | Your irrigation system at 16410 58th Ave N has been winterized. Technician notes: Blew out 6 zones. Thank you!                                                                                   |
| They cancel from their private link        | Your sign-up for 16410 58th Ave N has been cancelled. Sign up again anytime at <i>[site address]</i>                                                                                             |
| They use "Text me my link"                 | Manage your sign-up for 16410 58th Ave N: <i>[private link]</i>                                                                                                                                  |
| They try to sign up the same address twice | You're already registered. Manage your sign-up: <i>[private link]</i>                                                                                                                            |

**Replies.** Texts come from the site's Twilio number. If a neighbor replies **STOP**, Twilio stops sending them texts. Other replies aren't read by the website, so tell neighbors to call or text the organizer directly.

## Questions and troubleshooting

### A neighbor says they didn't get a text.

Look them up on the **Text log**. **simulated** means texting isn't set up yet. **failed** shows the reason underneath. If there's no entry, check on the Sign-ups tab that "no texts" isn't shown under their phone number. If it is, they opted out when signing up.

### A house shows "Not located" or isn't on the map.

Google couldn't find the address. Click **Edit**, correct the address (house number and street name), and save, or click **retry**. Houses that aren't on the map still appear in the technician's list, at the end of their half of the day.

### A date is full but I need to fit someone in.

Raise that date's morning or afternoon limit on the **Dates** tab. To add just one person, use **Edit**, choose the date, and tick **Allow over capacity**.

### The route order looks wrong.

Set the **Route start point** under Settings. The technician can also tap  **Re-plan from here**, or use /. Routes are planned by straight-line distance, so a river or dead end can occasionally make the order less than ideal.

### I did a test run and want to start the day over.

On the Dates tab, click **Reset status** for that date. To undo test completions, the technician can tap **Undo**, or you can edit each sign-up and set its status back to Scheduled.

### Someone needs to be moved to a specific date.

Click **Edit**, choose the **Scheduled day** and **Time of day**, tick **Text them if their date changes**, and save.

### The technician's location isn't showing.

Make sure **Share my location** is ticked and shows *(on)*, that the page is open on screen, and that location is allowed for the site in the phone's settings. Location sharing only works on the secure (https) address.

### The staff pages keep asking me to log in.

Logins last two weeks per device. If everyone is logged out after every update, the hosting is missing the `SESSION_SECRET` setting (see the Appendix).

## APPENDIX

# Hosting settings

For whoever manages the site on Railway. Settings are entered in Railway under the service's **Variables** tab. After changing them, deploy the changes when Railway prompts you. Never put passwords or keys in the GitHub repository.

| VARIABLE                                                          | WHAT IT'S FOR                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ADMIN_PASSWORD                                                    | Administrator password. Required.                                                                      |
| TECH_PASSWORD                                                     | Technician password. Required.                                                                         |
| SESSION_SECRET                                                    | Any long random string. Keeps staff logged in across updates.                                          |
| ADDRESS_SUFFIX                                                    | Plymouth, MN 55446 . Added to addresses so Google finds them in the neighborhood.                      |
| TZ_NAME                                                           | America/Chicago (the default). Used for "today".                                                       |
| GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY                                               | Google key with the Maps JavaScript API and Geocoding API turned on.                                   |
| TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID ,<br>TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN ,<br>TWILIO_FROM_NUMBER | Twilio account details and the number texts come from. Until these are set, texts show as "simulated". |
| DEFAULT_AM_CAPACITY ,<br>DEFAULT_PM_CAPACITY                      | Limits pre-filled for new dates (10 and 15).                                                           |
| BASE_URL                                                          | Only needed with a custom domain. Otherwise the Railway address is used automatically.                 |

## Keeping sign-ups safe

- The service needs a **volume** attached at `/data` . Without it, sign-ups are lost whenever the site updates.
- Keep the service at **one replica**.
- For a backup, use **Export CSV** on the admin Sign-ups tab.

## Google Maps key

In Google Cloud Console, limit the key to the site's address ( `https://your-site.up.railway.app/*` ) so others can't use it.

## Twilio

US texting from a website requires Twilio's business registration (A2P 10DLC) or a verified toll-free number. Until it's approved, texts may not be delivered.